

Catalogers Group
Minutes
December 22, 2005

***AIDS Poster Collection
Metadata/Cataloging Issues***

Present: B. Allahyar, S. Layne (moderator), L. Mendes (recorder) L. Ratliff, J. Riemer, R. Stumps, R. Villena

List of Issues:

1. Translations (titles, notes)
2. Subjects
3. Role (Agent relator code) for government bodies on posters
4. Names/Numbers printed on posters (Notes?)
5. Campaigns: how to treat them?
6. Inscription vs. Description (e.g., posters that have received an award)
7. Devising titles (form, wording, use of brackets)

Translations

Be careful! Do not rely on online translation systems! Online automatic translators provide literal (word-by-word) translation; unable to capture nuances of language (e.g., idiomatic expressions). Scholarly dictionaries often do not contain colloquial terms, slang, etc.

- Consult language expert!
- Do not translate text, title, if unsure!

NOTE: Pull up the record to be edited through the BROWSE, not THUMBNAIL!

Campaigns

The element "Relation.part of" has been eliminated since it requires the existence of a work record for all the posters in the series. How to treat "series-like" elements inscribed on posters? Most represent the AIDS/HIV campaigns. How to provide better access to them? Some options to consider:

- Title --> as Title.Inscribed
- Names/Agent --> Corporate names? For example, Stop AIDS International is an established corporate body in LCAF.
- Or, mixed approach: Treat some as titles and others as corporate names (role: Sponsor)

Note: It is not appealing to Catalogers Group to have "series-like" elements input in Description, since it is not an "access point" for collocation.

DECISION:. Proposal made here is pending review and approval by Angela Riggio.

Subjects

When to use TGM vs. LCSH? Or, Why are we using multiple thesauri?

1. different roles in subject analysis
2. different patrons -- different thesauri
3. whichever vocabulary has my term (hybrid approach)

Approach 1:

- TGM for both ofness & aboutness
- LCSH & MeSH for “one” overall AIDS/HIV-related aspect of poster (e.g., AIDS (Disease)—Transmission, etc.)

Approach 2:

- Use terms from different thesauri

Gay men [TGM]

Gay men [LCSH]

Approach 3:

- Most common approach so far. Catalogers have been using terms from both LCSH and/or TGM.

Discussion:

- Sara’s theoretical approach: Do not use one thesaurus for indexing ofness and a different one for aboutness!
- Consider assigning terms not found in TGM and coding it “blank.” Subject proposals will be made to TGM
- Continue the “hybrid” approach for ease of selection of appropriate terms

Current plan is to submit batches of TGM term proposals to LC later in the project.

Candidates for submission include those terms in the AIDS Posters database lacking any indication of a vocabulary and those “[LCSH]” terms clearly not related to AIDS/HIV.

To be continued...